

Fitness for Diabetes - ADA

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Get Active! | Exercise & Diabetes | ADA

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Health & Wellness Fitness It's a great time to get moving Whether you're just getting started or are an experienced athlete, regular physical activity is an important part of diabetes management. Image

Regular exercise can help put you in control of your life. If you're not into regular exercise, putting together an exercise plan can be a bummer. But remember, along with your diet and medications, regular physical activity is an important part of managing diabetes or dealing with prediabetes. Because when you're active, your cells become more sensitive to insulin so it works more effectively to lower your blood glucose, also known as blood sugar. (You might notice that exercising sometimes raises your blood glucose, find out why .) Exercise just makes you feel better. So, however you want to do it—taking regular walks around the block, going for a run, or signing up for a marathon—getting started is the most important part. How to get started exercising safely It doesn't matter where you are physically. If you've never set foot in a gym, that's okay—as long as you start doing something now. If you haven't been very active or are worried about your health, it's important to consult your doctor and start slowly. Light walking is a great place to start—and a great habit to incorporate into your life. Walk with a loved one, with your dog, or just by yourself while listening to an audio book. Set goals every day and meet them and you'll start feeling like you're back in control of your life. Learn more about how to get started safely. Even little changes make a big difference If you're still struggling with getting started or feeling overwhelmed by the idea of starting a more active life, take heart: every change, no matter how small, makes a difference in your ability to manage diabetes. Even losing 10–15 pounds can have a significant impact on your health. The power to change is firmly in your hands—so get moving today.

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Anaerobic vs. Aerobic Exercise

Even if you don't think you know what aerobic exercise is, chances are you know all about it.

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Overcome Roadblocks

Don't let roadblocks stop you from getting moving.

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[Exercise with Type 1](#)

Regardless of the type of diabetes you have, regular physical activity is important for your overall health and wellness.

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